



WORLD CUP 2026

LIVE DASHBOARD

User Guide & Developer Deep Dive

A single-file, real-time tournament dashboard
Powered by the ESPN public feed · AI features by Claude

Edition 1.0

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CHAPTER 1

Welcome

The World Cup 2026 Live Dashboard is a single web page that follows the entire tournament in real time — live scores and a play-by-play match tracker, group standings, the full knockout bracket, the Golden Boot race, news, and AI match predictions. It runs entirely in your browser, installs to your phone's home screen like an app, and is hosted for free on GitHub Pages.

What makes it different

- **Always live.** Scores, stats, standings, lineups and ball-by-ball commentary stream from ESPN's public feed and need no account or key.
- **One file.** The whole application is a single `index.html` — nothing to install, no server, no database.
- **Yours to theme.** Pick a favorite nation and the entire app re-skins to that team's colors and follows them.
- **An immersive live tracker.** A ticking match clock, an animated pitch that follows the flow of play, live win probability, a momentum graph, commentary, lineups, and a goal celebration when your team scores.
- **Optional AI.** Add your own Anthropic API key to unlock match predictions, player bios, and in-app goal-highlight clips.

NOTE — You don't need an API key to start

Every core feature — scores, the live tracker, standings, the bracket, the Golden Boot, news and commentary — works with no key at all. An Anthropic key only adds the AI extras described in Chapter 8.

CHAPTER 2

The Interface at a Glance

The top bar

Across the top you'll find the app title, three controls, and the tab row:

- **Favorite pull-down (“★ Favorite”).** Choose any nation to make it your team — see Chapter 3.
- **Settings (gear).** Where you paste your Anthropic API key (Chapter 8).
- **Alerts (bell).** Turns on goal notifications. The bell shows filled when alerts are on and tells you what happened when you tap it.

The seven tabs

Matches	Browse fixtures by day, see live/finished/upcoming games, and open any match. Your favorite team's next-match countdown sits at the top.
Standings	Live group tables (points, W-D-L, goal difference) for all twelve groups, computed from results as they happen.
Bracket	The full Round-of-32-to-Final knockout tree. During the group stage it shows projected qualifiers; real teams lock in as each group is decided.
Golden Boot	The top scorers. Tap a player to see each of their goals and watch a clip of each (Chapter 5).
News	Latest tournament headlines.
Predict	AI win/draw/win projections, predicted scorelines, and key factors for any matchup.
Fun	A reel of fun YouTube clips — first-time-in-America reactions, flamboyant fans, and Georgia visits, with filters (Chapter 7).

TIP — Tap anywhere on a match card

The whole card is a button. Live games open the Live Tracker, finished games open the review with highlights, and upcoming games open a preview with an AI prediction.

CHAPTER 3

Your Favorite Team

Choosing one team ties three things together: the app's color theme, which team you “follow,” and the next-match countdown.

Two ways to pick

- **The header pull-down** labeled “★ Favorite.” Choose any nation.
- **On a team's page**, tap “**Make [team] my team.**” Open a team page by tapping its name or flag anywhere in the app.

What happens when you pick a team

- The whole app **re-themes** to that nation's colors.
- The team is **followed** (its star fills in and it appears in the “Following only” filter).
- A **countdown** to that team's next kickoff appears at the top of the Matches tab — days, hours, minutes, seconds — and switches to a LIVE badge when they're playing.

NOTE — Following extra teams

The star on each match row lets you follow additional teams for the “Following only” filter, without changing your themed favorite. Your one themed team is whatever you pick in the pull-down or via “Make my team.”

HONEST LIMIT — Colors stay readable automatically

Some nations have very dark secondary colors (the USA's is navy). The app automatically lightens a too-dark accent so headings and labels never disappear against the dark background — so every team is a usable theme.

CHAPTER 4

Following a Match Live

Open any live game (the bright “Open Live Tracker” button) and you get a live-blog-style view designed to keep you in the match even when you can't watch the broadcast. It refreshes itself every few seconds.

What's on screen

Ticking clock	A minute-and-seconds clock that counts up between updates and re-syncs to the official minute. Handles half-time and stoppage time.
Big score	Pops gold the instant it changes.
Match progress bar	A marker sweeps from kickoff through half-time to full-time.
Animated pitch	A green field where a white ball follows the flow of play and a glow leans toward whichever side is pressing (see the note below).
Live win probability	A home / draw / away bar that swings with the score, time remaining and momentum. Clearly labeled as a model, not an official number.
Live stat tiles	Possession, shots, on-target, corners, fouls and cards — each flashes when its number changes.
Momentum + sparkline	A momentum bar plus a line graph that builds across the match.
Goal moments	Each goal with scorer and minute, plus an in-app highlight clip.
Live commentary	Real ball-by-ball text from the feed, newest first.
Lineups	Tap to expand both starting XIs, formations and substitutes.
Prediction	An AI read on the match (needs a key).

Goal celebration

When the score changes while you're watching, a full-screen “GOAL!” takeover fires with confetti and the scorer's name, your phone vibrates, and — if you've switched on the horn (the speaker icon in the tracker header) — a short goal horn plays.

HONEST LIMIT — About the pitch and the ball

No free data feed provides the real ball's position — that comes from expensive optical tracking systems. The moving ball here is an **approximation driven by the live commentary and possession**: it heads toward a goal on a shot, to the corner flag on a corner, into midfield on a foul, and drifts into the dominant team's half. It tracks *where the action is*, not the literal ball.

CHAPTER 5

Goals, Highlights & the Golden Boot

The Golden Boot tab ranks the tournament's scorers. Tap any player to open their card, which lists **every goal they've scored** — the minute, the match, the score, and penalty/own-goal flags — pulled straight from the match feed.

Comprehensive player profile

Opening a player now **auto-loads a full profile** (no extra tap): current club, age, position, preferred foot, height and squad number appear as chips, with dedicated sections for playing style, career arc, World Cup role and major honours. It is sourced from live web search and instructed never to invent facts, so any field it can't verify is simply left out. This needs your API key (Chapter 8); without one, the stat tiles stay blank.

Watching a goal

Each goal (in a player's card and in any finished match's review) has a **“Watch goal”** button. Tapping it embeds the official highlight **inside the app**, cued to that goal and trimmed to roughly ten seconds.

HONEST LIMIT — What the clips are — and aren't

These are the **official highlight videos embedded via YouTube**, automatically cued and trimmed to the goal. They are not rights-cleared, isolated broadcast cuts — that footage isn't available to a free app, and the app won't fake it. Resolving the right video uses web search, so it needs your API key when self-hosted, and it depends on the official clip existing on YouTube. Most goals resolve cleanly; some show an honest “no official clip found” state.

CHAPTER 6

Standings, Bracket, News & Predictions

Standings

Every group's table is computed live from finished results — points, wins, draws, losses, goals for/against and goal difference — with host nations flagged. Nothing is hand-entered; it all derives from the same match feed.

Bracket

The bracket shows the knockout path from the Round of 32 to the Final. During the group stage it is explicitly a projection: each slot shows the current projected qualifier and only **locks in a real team once that group is mathematically decided**. As knockout games finish, winners advance automatically.

NOTE — Group games aren't in the bracket

The bracket is knockout-only. A group-stage fixture (say, your team's next match) lives on the Matches tab and on the team's page, not in the bracket.

News

Headlines come from ESPN's feed; if that's unavailable and you have a key, the app falls back to an AI-summarized roundup.

Predict

Pick two teams (or use the upcoming-fixture shortcuts) for an AI projection: win/draw/win percentages, a predicted scoreline, and the key factors behind it. The same engine is built into every match modal.

IMPORTANT — Predictions are for fun

The win probabilities and predictions are model estimates, not betting advice.

CHAPTER 7

The Fun Tab

The Fun tab is a light-hearted reel built to keep you in the app between matches: short, good-natured videos of visitors experiencing America and of the tournament's most colourful travelling supporters.

What's in it

- **First-time-in-America reactions** — culture shock over giant portions, free refills, drive-thrus and Southern friendliness.
- **Flamboyant fans** — loud, vocal travelling supporters (Scotland's Tartan Army, Australia and more) taking over US cities.
- **Georgia & the South** — visitors discovering Atlanta, Waffle House, Buc-ee's and Peach State hospitality.

Filters and shuffle

Chip filters across the top narrow the reel: **All**, **World Cup**, **Food**, **Fans**, **Georgia**, **Shorts**. **Surprise me** reshuffles the whole reel into a fresh order. **Find fresh picks (AI)** pulls current, popular, embeddable clips via web search and merges them in (de-duplicated) — this one needs your API key (Chapter 8).

Watching a clip

Tap any thumbnail and the clip opens in an **expanded player** over the page. Close it (the x, tapping outside, or Esc) to return to the grid — only one clip plays at a time.

TIP — If a clip is silent, tap for sound

Phone browsers force the first unmute to come from a tap, so a clip may start muted. A **“Tap for sound”** button appears on the player — one tap enables audio. On desktop it plays with sound straight away.

HONEST LIMIT — Curated snapshot, not a guarantee

Picks reflect what's popular at curation time; rankings shift and creators can remove a video. Clips whose owners block off-YouTube playback show a clean “Watch on YouTube” panel instead. Everything here is kept good-natured and safe-for-work.

CHAPTER 8

Creating & Adding an Anthropic API Key

AI features — match predictions, player bios, news fallback, and goal-highlight clips — call Anthropic's API directly from your browser using **your own** key. Scores, the tracker, standings, the bracket and commentary never need one. This chapter walks through getting a key and adding it.

Part A — Create the key

- 1. Go to the developer console.** Open `console.anthropic.com` (it lands on the same developer console as `platform.claude.com`). Sign up or sign in with email or Google. You may be asked to verify a phone number.
- 2. Add billing first.** In the console, open **Settings → Billing** and add a payment method, then purchase a small amount of prepaid credit. This is the single most common fix for a brand-new key that “doesn't work” — until the account can be billed, requests are rejected. New accounts sometimes include a few dollars of trial credit.
- 3. Set a spending cap.** While you're in Billing, set a monthly spend limit so a runaway script can never surprise you. A casual day of using this dashboard costs only a few cents.
- 4. Create the key.** Click **API Keys** in the left sidebar (direct link: `platform.claude.com/settings/keys`), then **Create Key**. Give it a name like `worldcup-dashboard`.
- 5. Copy it now.** The key is shown **exactly once** and starts with `sk-ant-`. Copy it immediately. If you lose it, you simply revoke it and create a new one.

IMPORTANT — Treat the key like a password

Your key is a billing credential. Don't paste it into public chats, screenshots, or a public code file. If it ever leaks, revoke it in the console and create a replacement. A Claude.ai Pro/Max subscription is a separate product and does not include an API key.

Part B — Add the key to the app

- Open the app and tap the **Settings** (gear) icon in the top bar.
- Paste your `sk-ant-` key into the API-key field and save.
- That's it — predictions, bios and goal clips now work. The key is stored only in your browser.

NOTE — Where the key is stored

The key is saved in your browser's local storage on your device only — never in the app's code or repository. On a public GitHub Pages site, visitors do not see your key; each person would add their own. The app sends it straight to Anthropic with the browser-direct header, so anyone using your physical browser profile could read it — which is exactly why the spending cap in Part A is worth setting.

TIP — Roughly what it costs

The dashboard uses the Claude Sonnet model for short, infrequent calls (a prediction, a bio, a clip lookup). Typical usage is a few cents a day. Your spend cap is the hard ceiling.

CHAPTER 9

Troubleshooting & FAQ

I updated the app but my phone still shows the old version.

Phones and installed web apps cache aggressively. Hard-refresh the page, or if you added it to your home screen, remove that icon and re-add it after reloading.

A goal clip says “no official clip found.”

The official video for that exact goal wasn't found on YouTube, or no API key is set when self-hosted. Tap to retry, or add your key in Settings (Chapter 8).

The bell / alerts don't seem to do anything on my phone.

Browser goal alerts only fire reliably on desktop with the tab in the background. On phones the operating system suspends the page's timers in the background, so it can't detect a goal to notify you. While the app is open you still get the in-app goal pop-ups and celebration.

Predictions or bios won't load.

They need an API key with billing enabled. Check Settings, and confirm billing/credits are set up in the console (Chapter 8).

The live pitch ball sits in midfield.

It leans into the dominant team's half and reacts to commentary events; in a genuinely even, quiet passage it spends time near the center. It is an approximation of play, not real ball tracking.

Do I need to be online?

Yes for live data. The app caches the last data it loaded so it opens instantly and can show the most recent state briefly, but live updates need a connection.

CHAPTER 10

Technical Deep Dive (Developers)

This chapter is for anyone who wants to understand, modify, or re-deploy the app.

10.1 What it is

A single self-contained `index.html` — roughly 1,200 lines / ~116 KB: about 400 lines of CSS and ~755 lines of JSX/JavaScript, plus the HTML head. It is a client-only React application with no backend, no database, and no build step.

10.2 Stack & tooling

UI	React 18.3.1 (UMD) + ReactDOM, rendered with hooks.
Transpile	Babel-standalone 7.28.4 compiles the JSX in the browser at load time (a <code><script type="text/babel"></code> block).
CDN	All libraries load from <code>cdnjs.cloudflare.com</code> (the only allowed external script host).
Styling	Hand-written CSS with CSS custom properties for theming. Fonts: Anton + Inter (Google Fonts).
Build	None. No bundler, no TypeScript, no package step — edit the file and reload.
Hosting	GitHub Pages. The file must be named <code>index.html</code> at the repo root to serve as the site homepage.

NOTE — Why no build step

The no-tooling design is deliberate: the whole app is one file you can edit in any text editor and deploy by dragging it into a repo. The trade-off is in-browser Babel compile cost at load and no type-checking — acceptable for a personal project.

10.3 Data sources

High-frequency data comes from ESPN's free public soccer API (no key, CORS-open). Base path:

```
https://site.api.espn.com/apis/site/v2/sports/soccer/fifa.world
```

/scoreboard	All fixtures, scores, status, events (goals/cards), and team stats in one call. Parsed by <code>parseEvent()</code> .
/summary?event={id}	Per-match ball-by-ball commentary and lineups, parsed by <code>espnSummary()</code> . Drives the live commentary feed and the pitch ball.
/news	Headlines for the News tab.

Everything else is **derived on the client** from the scoreboard: standings (`deriveStandings`), top scorers (`deriveScorers`), a player's goals (`playerGoals`), the knockout tree (`buildBracket + resolveBracket`), live win probability (`winProb`), momentum, and team colors (`teamColorMap`).

10.4 The AI layer

Optional features call Anthropic's Messages API directly from the browser:

```
fetch("https://api.anthropic.com/v1/messages", {
  headers: {
    "x-api-key": <key from localStorage>,
    "anthropic-version": "2023-06-01",
    "anthropic-dangerous-direct-browser-access": "true"
  },
  body: { model: "claude-sonnet-4-6", ... }
})
```

Used by `fetchAnalysis` (predictions), `fetchBio` (comprehensive player profiles), `fetchNewsLLM` (news fallback), `fetchClip` (resolving an embeddable YouTube highlight + timestamp) and `fetchFun` (curating the Fun-tab reel). All use the web-search tool; responses are parsed defensively with an `extractJSON` helper.

10.5 Component map

App	State hub: holds board data, theme, favorites, the open modal, polling, and renders the tabs.
MatchCard	A single fixture card on the Matches tab.
MatchModal	The live tracker / review / preview. The largest component.
PitchView	The animated pitch; positions the ball from commentary + momentum.
LiveStat / Spark	Animated stat tiles and the momentum sparkline.

PlayerModal / GoalClip	A player's goals + auto-loaded full profile; GoalClip is the in-app trimmed highlight with block-detection fallback and per-goal caching.
TeamModal	A nation's page, with “Make my team.”
FunTab / VideoCard / FunModal	The Fun reel: filter chips + shuffle; thumbnails open FunModal, an expanded lightbox player with the watchdog fallback and tap-for-sound.
AlertBell / Settings	Goal-alert permission and the API-key field.
Mark / Star / StatBar / Countdown	Small shared UI primitives.

10.6 Theming engine

Picking a favorite calls `setFavoriteTeam`, which writes the team's ESPN colors into CSS variables `--teamA` / `--teamB` on the document root. `bright()` lightens a too-dark secondary color so accent text stays legible; `ink()` picks black-or-white for contrast on filled buttons. The group label deliberately uses the fixed gold accent so it's readable under any theme.

10.7 Live-data flow & polling

- Board (scoreboard) polls every **20s** when any game is live, otherwise every **120s**.
- An open live tracker polls that match every **~12s**; its summary (commentary/lineups) every **~10s**.
- A 1-second ticker drives the match clock and countdowns.
- All polling pauses when the tab is hidden; the last board is cached in `localStorage` for instant load.

10.8 Editing the file

Open `index.html` in any editor; the app is the JSX inside the `<script type="text/babel">` block. Common edits:

Change the AI model	Search for <code>claude-sonnet-4-6</code> and replace the model string.
Adjust polling speed	Search the <code>setInterval</code> values (20000 / 120000 / 12000 / 10000).

Re-tune the live pitch ball	Edit inferTarget (event keywords → pitch zones) and the flow interval in PitchView.
Change the win-probability model	Edit the winProb function.
Restyle	Edit the CSS in the <style> block, or the CSS variables at :root for the base palette.
Storage namespace	All localStorage keys are namespaced (wc2026_...); bump it to reset persisted state.

TIP — Validate before you deploy

Because there's no build step, a JSX typo only shows up at runtime (a blank page). Test by opening the file in a browser and checking the console before pushing. Keep a last-known-good copy so you can revert rather than layering fixes.

10.9 Deploying to GitHub Pages

- Put `index.html` at the repository root.
- In the repo: **Settings → Pages**, set the source to your main branch.
- Your site serves at `https://<user>.github.io/<repo>/`.
- After each push, hard-refresh (or remove/re-add the home-screen icon) to clear the cache.

10.10 Known constraints

- **No isolated goal video.** Clips are official YouTube highlights, trimmed/cued — not rights-cleared broadcast cuts.
- **No real ball tracking.** The pitch ball is an event/possession-driven approximation; live coordinates aren't in any free feed.
- **Models, not oracles.** Win probability and momentum are heuristics, labeled as such.
- **Background alerts are limited** on mobile (no service worker / push); foreground in-app alerts work.
- **AI needs the user's key** when self-hosted; ESPN data does not.

Appendix

Glossary

Board	The in-app array of parsed matches from the ESPN scoreboard.
Favorite / themed team	The one nation that colors the app and drives the countdown.
Following	Teams starred for the “Following only” filter (can be more than one).
Momentum	A derived 0-100 indicator of which side is on top, from possession and shots.
Win probability	A heuristic home/draw/away estimate from score, time and momentum.

Key endpoints

GET /scoreboard?dates=YYYYMMDD-YYYYMMDD	# all fixtures + live
GET /summary?event={id}	# commentary + lineups
GET /news	# headlines

Anthropic models referenced

In-app default	claude-sonnet-4-6 — fast, low-cost, used for all AI calls.
Key format	sk-ant-... (shown once at creation; revoke + recreate if lost).
Console	console.anthropic.com → Settings → Billing, then API Keys.

World Cup 2026 Live Dashboard — User & Developer Guide · Edition 1.0. Live data from the ESPN public feed; optional AI features by Claude (Anthropic). Highlight clips are official videos embedded via YouTube. Not affiliated with FIFA, ESPN, or Anthropic.